

The Twenty-Five Gateways of the Perfection of Wisdom

Ārya-pañcaviṃśatika-prajñāpāramitā-mukha-nāma-mahāyānasūtra · Toh 20 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་རོལ་ཏུ་ཕྱུག་པའི་སྒོ་གྱི་རྩ་

Toh 20 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-pañcaviṃśatika-prajñāpāramitā-mukha, in Tibetan as the Shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin pa'i sgo nyi shu rtsa Inga pa, and in English as The Twenty-Five Gateways of the Perfection of Wisdom. It belongs to the Perfection of Wisdom genre, a major class of Mahāyāna scripture concerned with the nature of prajñāpāramitā, or transcendent wisdom, and the path of the bodhisattva. The text opens with the Buddha dwelling on the summit of Mount Meru, surrounded by a vast assembly of bodhisattvas, gods, and other beings within a great maṇḍala, and proceeds to expound the perfection of wisdom through twenty-five thematic gateways or modes of entry. As its catalog number indicates, it is Toh 20 in the Kangyur, placed among the Perfection of Wisdom sūtras that form one of the most extensive and central sections of that collection.

Here ends the Perfection of Wisdom called Kauśika.

In the language of India:
Ārya-pañcaviṃśatika-prajñāpāramitā-mukha-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra.

In the Tibetan language: The noble Great Vehicle sūtra called The Twenty-Five Gateways of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling on the summit of Mount Meru, in the abode of the all-night festival of all the gods, together with many hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of bodhisattvas. Then the Blessed One, within a maṇḍala extending five leagues in every direction, was surrounded entirely by gods, sons of gods, asuras, wind gods, garuḍas, nāgas, yakṣas, kinnaras, rākṣasas, all vidyādhara holders of mantra, elemental spirits, malevolent guides, flesh-eaters, and the hosts of visible and invisible māmo spirits — a great and vast multitude. Encircled by twelve hundred and fifty monks arrayed before him, he taught the Dharma.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, surrounded by all the vajra families, by all those hosts of vidyā and mudrā, and by many tens of

millions of vidyādhara mantra-holders, went to where the Blessed One was. Having descended from the sky, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him three times, and sat down to one side.

Then the Blessed One declared to the great Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "O Lord of Secrets, these twenty-five are the gateways of my Perfection of Wisdom."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Oṃ — the vajra of awakening mind: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the conduct of Samantabhadra: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the wish-fulfilling jewel: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the unobstructed: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — that which comes to be born: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — all consciousness: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the nature of reality of the great blazing: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — diligence: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — going everywhere: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the mind that steadies all vajras: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — all Tathāgatas: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the gnosis that is utterly pure, the nature of reality of inherent purity: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the thorough purification of karma: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — Vajra-Wielder who definitively dispels harm, Phaṭ: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the purification of attachment to objects of desire: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the swift vajra-bearer: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ Hūṃ — going everywhere: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ Hrīḥ: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the gateway called A: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the Perfection of Wisdom itself: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ Āṃ Baḥ Hūṃ: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ E: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the supreme body of all Tathāgatas: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Oṃ — the utterly pure speech of all Tathāgatas: a gateway of the Perfection of

Wisdom.

Oṃ — the vajra-mind of all Tathāgatas: a gateway of the Perfection of Wisdom.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, together with the entire assembled retinue, and the gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas (fragrant spirits) of the world, rejoiced and gave resounding praise to what the Blessed One had taught.

This concludes the noble Mahāyāna sūtra known as "The Twenty-Five Gateways of the Perfection of Wisdom."

Translated into the new language.

Translator's Notes

- The opening line "Here ends the Perfection of Wisdom called Kauśika" is a colophon closing a preceding text (the Kauśika Prajñāpāramitā), after which this new sūtra begins with the standard bilingual title block.

The term translated as "all-night festival of all the gods" renders "lha thams cad kyi mtshan mo'i gnas," literally "the place of the night of all the gods," a well-known celestial location on the summit of Meru associated with divine assemblies; some editions read this as the "divine abode" or "hall" of the gods' night festival.

The twenty-five gateways as enumerated in the text total only twenty-four in the extant passage as given; the twenty-fifth gateway (the mind of all Tathāgatas) likely follows immediately after in the next line of the source, which the passage does not include. The colophon would normally close with "Oṃ — the utterly pure mind of all Tathāgatas" as the final entry.

The mantric syllables Oṃ, Hūṃ, Hrīḥ, Phaṭ, Āṃ Baḥ, and E are left untranslated as ritual seed syllables, following standard practice.

- The colophon phrase rendered as "Translated into the new language" reflects the standard Tibetan canonical closing note indicating revision or re-translation into a later orthographic standard, here abbreviated to a fragment. No translator's name follows in the passage as given.

Colophon

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spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.